

Let's talk environmental impacts of AI... detection

Posted by u/Tyler_Zoro • 0 points • 7 comments

I've seen many recent demands that social media services identify and make optional for all users, any AI-generated content.

Doing this for locally generated content would be trivial and would cost no extra resources.

However, doing this in general would require that ALL CONTENT be passed through AI detectors, which are, themselves, AI models. This means that, for example, Instagram would have to pass every photo anyone ever uploaded through an AI detection AI model, scaling the use of AI in their infrastructure by what would likely be an order of magnitude.

If we're going to talk about the environmental cost of AI (and even just in electricity production there clearly is *some* cost) we have to talk about these sorts of massive scale applications of AI technology that take everything we did yesterday and add a new AI component. Shouldn't we be trying to avoid such step functions in the use of AI when there is little practical benefit (especially as AI detectors have notoriously proven prone to both false positives and false negatives)?

Comments

u/thesishauntsme • 2 points • 2025-10-28 02:59 UTC

yeah this is actually such a good point. like ppl keep yelling for "detect AI everywhere" but no one talks about how much extra compute that adds lol. the irony is we'd burn way more power just to maybe flag a few false positives. honestly, feels like smarter humanization is the better route... like tools that make AI writing more natural instead of wasting energy trying to detect it. been messing w/ walterwrites ai lately and it's kinda wild how human it feels. probably one of the best ai humanizer tools out there for real.

u/jsand2 • 1 points • 2025-10-27 20:45 UTC

I say let's force the use of AI to spot AI. Lets ruin the world even more than without AI detectors, just so the antis can sleep better at night.

Note: I dont care about the antis. They are pretty much the butt of the joke at this point. But they deserve nothing less.

Also, I don't believe AI has the environmental impacts that are pushed by the anti-AI propaganda machines. It's just a bunch of gatekeepers sad that they are going to lose to a tool that allows anybody to make quality art.

u/Tyler_Zoro • 1 points • 2025-10-28 02:18 UTC

> I say let's force the use of AI to spot AI. Let's ruin the world even more than without AI detectors, just so the antis can sleep better at night.

That's a hell of a lot of power consumption for zero benefit, not even an aesthetic benefit. You're just throwing power and money down the drain for... what? To placate a moral panic? I assure you that that's not how moral panics work. They'll be yelling about the same things tomorrow, but even louder.

> Also, I don't believe AI has the environmental impacts that are pushed by the anti-AI propaganda machines

Sure, but there isn't zero cost to passing everything ever posted to any social media network through an AI model. I don't think you understand how gigantic an ask that is. It's not just AI-generated content. It's every photo ever taken, it's every meme ever slapped together, it's everything!

u/Ok_Investment_5383 • 2 points • 2025-10-26 06:38 UTC

That's a good point, and tbh I don't think most people realize how much compute actually goes into large scale detection. I worked for a data team at a crypto swap platform and even just analyzing basic user uploads for fraud was a headache, resource-wise - cost spikes, latency issues, a ton of wasted energy on false alarms.

Passing literally every single piece of content through an AI detector like you're saying? Multiply the resource drain by the number of posts per second and it doesn't even sound feasible without insane server scaling.

Some detection platforms are trying to address these challenges - AIDetectPlus, for example, emphasizes more efficient batch scanning and adjustable sensitivity to cut down on unnecessary processing, and Copyleaks and GPTZero seem to be iterating on lighter models as well. Maybe combining batch analysis + metadata checks is the way forward, rather than brute-forcing everything. Otherwise, not sure the social trust boost really balances out the environmental cost.

u/SeaNeighborhood7205 • 1 points • 2025-10-28 00:53 UTC

The only sane path is selective, staged detection, not "scan everything."

What's worked for me:

↳ Gate by reach and risk: heavy models only for trending/paid posts, first-time posters, or if flagged; sample 1–5% of the long tail.

↳ Cascade the pipeline: metadata/EXIF and perceptual hash first, then a tiny distilled model, escalate to a heavier detector only on ambiguous cases.

\- Cache aggressively: pHash/SimHash and embedding dedupe so reposts and near-dupes don't get rescanned.

\- Batch non-urgent checks off-peak and run carbon-aware scheduling; keep upload-time checks ultra-cheap to avoid latency spikes.

\- Verify watermarks (SynthID/Stable Signature) when present, but never rely on them alone.

I've seen AIDetectPlus's batch mode help with cost smoothing; Copyleaks and GPTZero are decent for a lightweight first pass if you keep thresholds conservative to limit false alarms.

We wired Cloudflare Workers for heuristic gating and Kafka for events; DreamFactory just exposed our Snowflake tables as REST so detectors could log scores without new microservices.

Net: selective, staged detection with caching and reach-based gating beats brute-force scanning every upload.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-10-25 13:55 UTC

[removed]

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-10-25 13:55 UTC

In an effort to discourage brigading, we do not allow linking to other subreddits or users. We kindly ask that you screenshot the content that you wish to share, while being sure to censor private information, and then repost.

Private information includes names, recognizable profile pictures, social media usernames, other subreddits, and URLs. Failure to do this will result in your post being removed by the Mod team and possible further action.

I am a bot, and this action was performed automatically. Please [contact the moderators of this subreddit](/message/compose/?to=/r/aiwars) if you have any questions or concerns.

u/Spam_Altman • 1 points • 2025-10-24 04:43 UTC

AI detectors do not work. Kiss reality goodbye while you can because it's about to get weird.

u/Tyler_Zoro • 2 points • 2025-10-24 04:46 UTC

>> AI detectors have notoriously proven prone to both false positives and false negatives

> AI detectors do not work

Yes... what's your point. I said that.

u/Spam_Altman • 1 points • 2025-10-24 05:06 UTC

Yo, you slow or what? You tryin' to act like we speakin' the same language, but you ain't even in the same book.

You talkin' 'bout "prone to." That's soft. That's what you say when some shit mostly works but stumbles. Like a guard dog that barks at the mailman. It's flawed.

I SAID. THEY. DO. NOT. WORK.

That means the dog ain't just barkin' wrong, it's a stuffed animal. It's a prop. It's all show and no go. It ain't "flawed," it's fake. It's a hollow point with no powder.

You cryin' about a leaky faucet. I'm tellin' you there's no water in the damn pipes.

Don't you ever put your weak-ass words next to mine again.

u/Tyler_Zoro • 1 points • 2025-10-24 15:38 UTC

> Yo, you slow or what?

Ad hominem is certainly not a sign of good faith discussion...

> I SAID. THEY. DO. NOT. WORK.

Yes, that's what I said. Why are you repeating what I said?

> Don't you ever put your weak-ass words next to mine again.

This is starting to sound like you fired up ChatGPT and asked it to rudely insult someone. Let's maybe have a rational discussion?

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-10-24 15:58 UTC

[removed]

u/kjj34 • 1 points • 2025-10-23 17:34 UTC

Why would that be the solution instead of regulations that require content to be flagged as AI-generated via watermarks/content metadata at the point of creation?

u/Tyler_Zoro • 2 points • 2025-10-23 19:24 UTC

That's not a solution, that's a wish. There's no practical way to enforce such a rule, so it just becomes a business restriction for the largest companies.

I have AI models on my computer that no one can ever modify and which can crank out watermark-free images until the end of time. Don't tell me that you honestly believe that bad actors won't have the same.